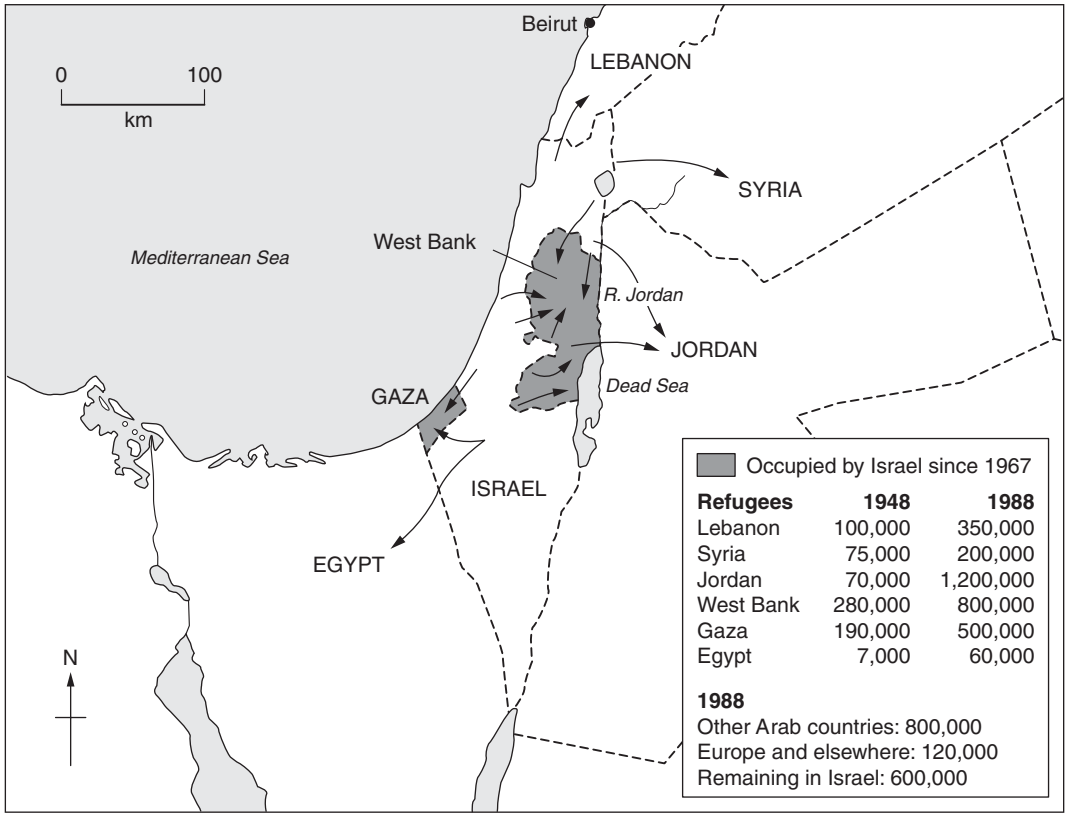


Palestinian refugees 1948–9.

Middle East. The conditions are described below, first by a British observer, then by a refugee and, finally, by a UN official:

> The conditions in the camps were atrocious. Families huddled bleakly in overcrowded tents. They were without adequate food or sanitation. When it rained, the narrow paths along each row were churned into mud which oozed into the tents. They lived in sodden clothes and slept in wet blankets. Influenza reached epidemic proportions. The young and old perished. Malnourished children were too weak to resist, and the old, left with no purpose, lacked the will.
>
> (Jonathan Dimbleby, a British observer, comments in *The Palestinians*, 1979)

> A few months after our arrival, we were penniless and had to move into a refugee camp with 2000 other homeless Palestinians. It is beyond human endurance for a family of 11 to live in a small tent through all the seasons of the year on UNRWA rations. Fathers buried their children who died of hunger. Some buried their fathers who died of disease. On winter days we all crawled together to gain the warmth of humans.
>
> (Ghazi Daniel, a refugee remembers, in an account published by the PLO, 1972)